

LUXURY GOES ELECTRIC

Mercedes-Benz EQS 580 4MATIC
Engine Dual electric motor
Power 524bhp
Torque 850Nm
Gearbox Single-speed
Price Rs 1.55 crore (ex-showroom)

WE FIND OUT WHAT IT'S LIKE TO DRIVE THE S-CLASS'S ELECTRIC EQUIVALENT ON INDIAN ROADS

BY YOGENDRA PRATAP

Mercedes has been able to price the EQS 580 rather well and that is due to the benefit that electric cars get under the new GST regime. Being assembled in India, the car attracts a GST of just 5 per cent overall as opposed to the S-Class's 50 per cent.

In size, the EQS is similar to the S-Class, being just 28mm narrower and 73mm shorter, with a wheelbase that is just 6mm shorter. However, the EQS is distinctive with its bow-like cab-forward design with a fastback style at the rear and a black panel at the front. The overall shape and the various design elements lead it to the best coefficient of drag ever seen on a production car of 0.20 that helps it achieve an ARAI-certified range of 857km.

While the exteriors are striking, the interiors look revolutionary with the MBUX Hyperscreen that incorporates three displays—one 17.7-inch at the centre, a 12.3-inch instrument cluster and a similarly sized screen for the front passenger. The seating is ultra luxurious with the rear seats also adjustable for recline while a 15-speaker Burmester surround sound system provides a fantastic aural experience.

The EQS 580 4MATIC is driven by two motors, one on each axle, producing a combined system output of over 500bhp and 850Nm. The motors are powered by a 107.8kWh lithium-ion NMC high energy density battery. The vehicle comes with a standard three-phase AC wallbox charger that can be installed for a full charge in about 10 hours.



To drive the EQS feels like it rides on air, and power is there on tap with sports-car-like acceleration. It is also extremely manoeuvrable thanks to rear-wheel drive steering that can turn the rear wheels by up to 10 degrees. Steering is light and very easy, and there are multiple modes to recuperate energy. Equipped with an air suspension, the car is raised by 25mm, much needed for our less-than-perfect roads. In addition, there are a host of driver aids and assistance systems focused on enhancing convenience and safety.

With the EQS 580, not only does one get a car that is luxurious, at the forefront of tech and green at the same time, it does away with range anxiety with a range comparable to ICE cars and drives like a sports car when one does want to indulge in some spirited driving. ■